

toolbar. A number of Web components such as tagging rules, meta tags, etc have been added to the menu items. InDesign, on the other hand, sports an entire menu for its table option. It still isn't very intuitive with its tabbed toolbars and other options hidden under another tab. Quark, in that respect, manages to place most of the frequently used tools in the Measurements toolbar, and a right-click and 'Modify' option gives you all the options related to the text or picture box. For instance, in Quark you can right-click on a picture box, select 'Modify' and set the text wrap or runaround, change the box background, the frame outline size, etc. To do the same thing in InDesign you would first have to view the Text Wrap toolbar, then use the Stroke toolbar to add the border, and then use swatches or colour to change the border colour.

However, Quark still employs a rigid framework for placing text or pictures (you have to be in a text box or a picture box with the content tool selected), while InDesign allows you to place text from anywhere. A frequently used option that figures when you right-click the text or picture box in both InDesign and Quark is the 'Fit content to box' or 'Fit box to content' options. InDesign even includes the fit content proportionately option when you right-click (it's available as a Menu item in Quark), so you do not have to bother about resizing your picture box. InDesign takes round 5 too.

Score: Adobe 1 Quark 0

The winner

Feature for feature, whether it's tables,

Who's Buying

Worldwide, the desktop publishing market is fairly fragmented. At the lower end of the scale, Adobe PageMaker and Microsoft Publisher target desktop users and DTP operators. These software are being used for basics such as research or thesis reports, small newsletters, greeting cards, mass mailers, etc. Designers and graphics professionals working with media houses or advertising agencies use a mix of QuarkXPress and Adobe InDesign—Quark is still the leader. Book publishers either choose Adobe FrameMaker for their specialised requirements with long documents, or use PageMaker. But in India, the scenario is somewhat different. Most of the desktop publishing shops you see around the corner work with PageMaker extensively for a variety of tasks ranging from advertisements to reports. The reasons may be that PageMaker is more easily 'available' than QuarkXPress. A higher-end design setup such as a publishing house or advertising agency works mainly with QuarkXPress. InDesign is still not a favourite with anybody. The scenario might change a little with InDesign 2.0, but that depends a lot on the pricing bundle offered for an upgrade from QuarkXPress and Adobe's ability to convince pre-press units about the output quality of InDesign.



transparency options, text handling and manipulation options or outputting to different formats, Adobe InDesign 2.0 is superior. InDesign works almost like a word processor in most respects. However, Quark scores in its usage of layers and Web formatting.

The features of Tables and Layers are reason enough for most designers to upgrade from Quark 4.x to version 5, while InDesign 1.x users will love the transparency options as also the ability to create tables. Quark 5 can save as version 4 but the layers option won't be available and the cells in tables get converted into individual text boxes aligned to each other.

Decision Maker		
Current software	Nature of work	Go for
Adobe InDesign 1.x	Dealing with text and images extensively for newsletters, brochures, covers	Adobe InDesign 2.0
Quark 4.x/3.x	Dealing with text and images in not so long documents. Working with image-editing software too	Quark 5.0
Adobe PageMaker 6.x/7.0	Dealing mainly with text; working on long documents	Retain the same software
	Dealing with text and images and not so long documents	Adobe InDesign 2.0
New purchase of desktop publishing software	Not so long documents, with images	Adobe InDesign 2.0
	Long documents mainly dealing with text, such as a book	Quark 5.0

Designers working extensively with images, especially brochures, newsletters or covers will find that InDesign 2.0 integrates a number of functions and provides for a number of text effects that otherwise would have had to be done in Photoshop. InDesign even provides a filter to directly open Quark 4.x

and earlier version files in InDesign, and the conversion is quite smooth, though you will still have to do some touch-up. InDesign doesn't come with any option to save in a previous version.

If you use a software like PageMaker and deal with images a lot, you can shift to InDesign. This software has the capability to open PageMaker versions too. However, if your main work still relates to text composition, then PageMaker is still better at that.

As a new purchase for text and image handling, Adobe InDesign 2.0 is a better option than Quark, though it would be first advisable to check with your pre-press unit for problems relating to outputting from InDesign.

Overall, Quark still retains the simplicity of its earlier versions even though it lacks various other features. In fact, you can easily get lost among the various features of InDesign. However, designers working on Adobe Photoshop and Illustrator may find the interface of InDesign quite familiar and take a liking to it.

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